

MLFF-DATA9A5: Critical-FP64 MACE Execution

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1. Purpose

DATA9A5 separates the precision of the expensive MACE body from the precision of numerically sensitive global operations. The user may train and execute the model body in either `float32` or `float64`, while mdstats safety-locks critical reductions, returned observables, and persistent ASE MD state to `float64`.

This stage is intended for consumer GPUs such as the RTX 3090, where a complete FP64 MACE calculation is much slower than FP32 but long MD trajectories still benefit from accurate global reductions and double-precision state updates.

2. Model-body precision

Training precision remains selected by:

```
MaceOptimizerPolicy(default_dtype="float32")  
MaceOptimizerPolicy(default_dtype="float64")
```

Python/ASE

inference

precision is selected independently through `MaceCalculatorProvider.from_model_path(default_dtype=...)` or `build_mace_critical_precision_calculator(model_dtype=...)`.

Only `float32` and `float64` are accepted. The selected training dtype remains part of `TrainingProtocolIdentity`; inference dtype is recorded in the model checkpoint identity.

3. Safety-locked critical precision

`MaceCriticalPrecisionPolicy` requires:

- atomic reference-energy accumulation in FP64;
- interaction-energy accumulation in FP64;
- total-energy output in FP64;
- virial and stress reduction in FP64;
- force, virial, stress, atomic-energy, and global-energy outputs in FP64;
- persistent ASE positions, cell, masses, and momenta in FP64;
- TensorFlow-32 disabled;
- inference forces differentiated from the same FP64-accumulated energy used for the reported potential energy.

The reference and learned interaction energies are reduced separately before being combined. Node-energy reductions use graph-contiguous FP64 segment sums, avoiding an FP32 system-energy reduction.

4. Training autograd boundary

MACE 0.3.16 force training requires second derivatives through an e3nn/MACE force graph. An FP64 scalar seed propagated through a FP32 force-Jacobian path causes an upstream dtype failure. Therefore, optimization-time energy, force, and stress graphs remain entirely in the user-selected model dtype.

This exception is explicit and immutable:

```
training_force_jacobian_dtype = model
```

Validation, standalone evaluation, descriptor/prediction inference, and Python ASE MD use the critical-FP64 path. Thus FP32 training remains supported while production trajectory observables and reductions are double precision.

5. Runtime implementation

The first implementation is version-locked to:

- `mace-torch==0.3.16`;
- `mace.modules.models.ScaleShiftMACE`;
- the Python/ASE calculator execution path.

`install_mace_critical_fp64_patch()` installs the explicit runtime forward adapter. It fails closed for any other MACE version. The `mdstats` command wrappers install it before real training, evaluation, or head-selection jobs:

- `mdstats-mace-train`;
- `mdstats-mace-eval`;
- `mdstats-mace-select-head`.

LAMMPS, ML-IAP, Kokkos, LibTorch, and accelerator execution are downstream consumer responsibilities. This stage does not inspect, reproduce, or qualify their internal mixed-precision behavior. `mdstats` supplies a uniformly FP32 or FP64 serialized model and makes no downstream runtime-precision claim.

6. Audits

`MaceCriticalPrecisionAudit` records the MACE version, model class, model-body dtype, global output dtypes, TF32 state, patch state, and policy digest. It passes only when critical outputs are FP64 and TF32 is disabled.

`AseMdStatePrecisionAudit` records positions, cell, masses, and optional momenta. `audit_ase_md_state_precision(..., require_momenta=True)` fails before MD when any persistent state array is not FP64 or when velocities/momenta are absent.

7. Numerical interpretation

Casting final FP32 results to FP64 cannot restore precision lost inside the FP32 equivariant body. DATA9A5 instead prevents additional loss in global energy/virial reduction and repeated MD-state updates. A full FP64 model remains available when internal FP32 force error is scientifically unacceptable.

8. Acceptance requirements

DATA9A5 is accepted only when:

1. FP32 and FP64 training protocols remain independently selectable;
2. FP32 and FP64 Python inference remain independently selectable;
3. TF32 is disabled by the execution policy;
4. a real FP32 MPA-0 calculation returns FP64 energy, force, virial, and stress;
5. the patched FP64 path agrees with upstream full-FP64 MACE to numerical precision;
6. a one-epoch FP32 transfer job completes and the saved model is uniformly FP32;
7. a one-epoch FP64 transfer job remains supported;
8. both saved models pass the post-training critical precision audit;
9. ASE MD-state audits round-trip and fail closed on FP32 momenta;
10. all policy and audit records reject digest tampering.

DATA9A5 does not complete production DATA6-DATA8 realization and does not open DATA9B by itself.